# Mario Leccese

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## Academic Appointments and Affiliations

**University of Chicago, Booth School of Business** 2026 -
Affiliate Fellow of the Stigler Center

**Boston University, Questrom School of Business** 2024 -
Assistant Professor in Strategy & Innovation

## Education

**University of Maryland**

Ph.D., Economics 2024
*Dissertation:* "Essays on Competition and Innovation"
*Committee:* Ginger Zhe Jin, Andrew Sweeting,
Liad Wagman, Chenyu Yang and Rajshree Agarwal

M.A., Economics 2020

**Bocconi University**

M.Sc., Economics (DES) 2017
B.Sc., Economics (CLES) 2015

## Research Interests

Industrial Organization, Strategy, Antitrust & Competition Policy, Economics of Innovation, Venture Capital & Entrepreneurship.

## Publications

[1] Should We Expect Uncertain Synergies To Be Passed Through to Consumers? (with Andrew Sweeting and Xuezhen Tao). **The Journal of Industrial Economics**, Vol. 73(1), pp.1-30, 2025.

[2] Taxing Ride-sharing: Which Neighborhoods Pay More? **Journal of Regional Science**, Vol. 64(4), pp.1393-1413, 2024.

[3] M&A and Technological Expansion (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). **Journal of Economics & Management Strategy**, Vol. 3(2), pp. 338-359, 2024.

[4] How Do Top Acquirers Compare in Technology Mergers? New Evidence from an S&P Taxonomy (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). **International Journal of Industrial Organization**, Vol. 89, 2023.

[5] M&A and Innovation: A New Classification of Patents (with Zhaoqi Cheng, Ginger Zhe Jin, Dokyun Lee and Liad Wagman). **American Economic Association: Papers & Proceedings**, Vol. 113, pp. 288-293, May 2023.

## Book Chapters

[6] The Role of Digital Platforms in Shaping Tech Venture Innovation (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). Chapter in the **Handbook on Digital Platforms**, edited by Anthony Dukes, D. Daniel Sokol, Tianshu Sun, and Feng Zhu, Cambridge University Press (forthcoming). Also available as NBER WP #33370.

## Other Publications

[7] Public comments submitted to the EU Commission on the review of the Digital Markets Act (with Ginger Jin, Jorge Klinnert and Liad Wagman), September 2025.

[8] The Draft Merger Guidelines Risk Reducing Innovation (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). ProMarket, October 2023.

[9] Public comments submitted to the DOJ/FTC Request for Information regarding the Draft Merger Guidelines (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman), July 2023. Available at: https://www.regulations.gov/comment/FTC-2023-0043-1429.

[10] Asymmetric Taxation, Pass-through and Market Competition: Evidence from Ride-sharing and Taxis. Proceedings of the 2022 ACM Conference on Economics and Computation, 371–372. New York, NY, USA:Association for Computing Machinery.

[11] Public comments submitted to the DOJ/FTC Request for Information on Merger Enforcement (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman), March 2022. Available at: https://www.regulations.gov/comment/FTC-2022-0003-0138.

## Working Papers

[1] The Effects of Targeted Platform Taxes: Evidence from Ride-sharing and Taxis. 2022. SSRN working paper #3824453. *Revise and Resubmit* at the Journal of Public Economics.

[2] Dynamic Seller Competition When Buyers Have Bargaining Power (with Shanglyu Deng, Calvin Jia and Andrew Sweeting). 2023. NBER working paper #32360: "Dynamic Competition with Bargaining." *Revise and Resubmit* at the Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics.

[3] The Signaling Value of Technology Venture Acquisitions (with Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). 2024. SSRN working paper #4943381. *Revise and Resubmit* at the Strategic Management Journal.

[4] Strategic Investment in Competitors: Theory and Evidence from Technology Startups. 2024. SSRN working paper #4968068.

[5] Hiding a Flaw? Experimental Evidence on Multi-Dimensional Information Disclosure (with Agata Farina). 2024. SSRN working paper #4785923.

[6] How Does Privacy Regulation Affect Transatlantic Venture Investment? Evidence from GDPR (with Jian Jia, Ginger Zhe Jin and Liad Wagman). 2025. NBER working paper #33909. SSRN working paper #3436535.

[7] Serial Acquisitions in Tech (with Ginger Zhe Jin, Liad Wagman and Yunfei Wang). 2025. SSRN working paper #5392628. NBER working paper #34178. *Revise and Resubmit* at the Review of Economics and Statistics.

[8] The Hart-Scott-Rodino Act at Fifty: Acquisition Patterns and Industry Dynamics (with Ginger Jin, Daniel Sokol, Liad Wagman, and Mengyi Zhong), July 2026. SSRN working paper #6979178.

## Conference Presentations and Invited Seminars

*2026:* ASSA Meeting; Next Generation of Antitrust Conference; Utah Antitrust Summit; NBER Law & Economics Spring Meeting; Utah Winter Strategy Conference; IIOC; EIEF; Oxera; Equitable Growth Seminar; BU Platform Strategy Symposium (PhD Consortium Discussant); Academy of Management; EARIE; Boston University; Stigler Fellows Conference at University of Chicago Booth; HSR at 50 Conference at Georgetown (Schedued); Harvard Business School–Strategy (Scheduled); FTC Annual Microeconomics Conference (Scheduled); NBER Place-Based Policies and Entrepreneurship (Discussant, Scheduled); CEPR Industrial Organization–Paris Symposium (Scheduled); Unibg IO Winter Symposium (Scheduled)

*2025:* Unibg IO Winter Symposium; Antitrust Merger Platform Policy Roundtable; Annual National Tax Association Conference (Discussant); BU IO Seminar; CRESSE (Presenter and Discussant); BSE Summer Forum; EAYE Annual Conference; IIOC (Presenter and Discussant); NBER Productivity Seminar; Digital Business Institute Research Showcase, Boston University; BYU/USC Winter Antitrust Conference

*2024:* Harvard-Oxford Conference on Common Ownership; Southern Economic Association Annual Conference; Digital Platforms Symposium at USC Marshall; 51st Annual Conference of EARIE; BSE Summer Forum (Economics of Science and Innovation); DRUID; University of Maryland Smith School of Business; USC Gould School of Law

*2023:* Boston University, Questrom School of Business; University of Toronto, Rotman School of Management; ESADE Business School; Universitat Pompeu Fabra; Universidad Carlos III de Madrid; Georgia Institute of Technology, Scheller College of Business; WEFI Student Workshop; University of Maryland (Dept. of Economics); University of Maryland Smith School of Business (Finance); University of Maryland Smith School of Business (Strategy); WEFI Student Workshop; NFI-NBIM-Oxford Conference on Common Ownership (Discussant)

*2022:* NBER Conference on Megafirms and the Post-COVID Economy; 23rd ACM Conference on Economics & Computation; Urban Economics Association North American Meeting; Conference on The Business Revolution of Digital Transformation at USC; GMU Law&Economics Center Research Roundtable on The Data-Competition Interface; 5th International Conference of China Development Studies

*2021:* IIOC Rising Stars; MACCI Annual Conference

## Grants, Honors and Awards

Mehrotra Institute's Research Grant ($20,000, PI) 2026
Project: "Antitrust Beyond Prices"

International Center for Law & Economics Research Grant ($60,000, Co-PI) 2025
Project: "Post-Acquisition Career Paths of Founders in the Digital Economy"

Finalist 2024 Antitrust Writing Awards: Academic Articles, Mergers 2024
Concurrences

University of Maryland BSOS Dean's Research Initiative 2023
Travel Grant ($1,000)

Washington Center for Equitable Growth Doctoral Grant ($15,000, PI) 2022
Project: "Startups' Common Ownership and Competition in Technology Markets"

Program on Economics and Privacy at GMU Research Grant ($7,000) 2022
Project: "How Do Top Acquirers Compare in Technology Mergers?"

University of Maryland Faculty-Student Research Award 2022
Research Grant ($10,000), with Ginger Zhe Jin

Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant 2022
University of Maryland

Best Third Year Paper Award ($2^{nd}$ prize) 2021
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

University of Maryland Graduate School Summer Research Fellowship 2021
Stipend to support research activities ($5,000)

University of Maryland BSOS Dean's Research Initiative 2020, 2021
Research Grants ($1,500 and $3,248, respectively)

Graduate Research Assistantship 2021-2023
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

Graduate Teaching Assistantship 2019-2021
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

First-year Graduate Fellowship 2018-2019
Department of Economics, University of Maryland

## Teaching

Entrepreneurial Strategy 2026
MBA elective, Boston University

Strategy, Innovation, and Global Competition 2025-2026
Undergraduate, Boston University

Research Seminar in Technology Strategy and Innovation 2025
Ph.D., Boston University

Intermediate Microeconomics 2020-2021
Undergraduate, University of Maryland

## University and Department Service

**Doctoral Advising and Committees**
Zeyang Xue (Boston University, Committee Member, current)

**Master Students and Past Research Assistants**
Rayna Yang (Placement: Boston University, PhD in Information Systems)
Daling Shi (Placement: University of Miami, PhD in Biomedical Informatics)

Co-organizer of the Doctoral Consortium of the Platform Strategy Symposium 2026
Boston University

Organizer of the Strategy & Innovation Research Seminar 2025-
Boston University

Organizer of the Industrial Organization Seminar 2024-
Boston University

Strategy & Innovation Department, Search committee for Assistant Professor 2024, 2026
Boston University

Member of the Academic Conduct Committee 2024-2025
Boston University

## Professional Service

**Referee for:** *Applied Economics Letters*, *DRUID Annual Conference*, *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, *Journal of Regional Science*, *Metroeconomica*, *RAND Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Industrial Organization*, *Strategic Management Society Annual Conference*

Young Economist Representative of the Transportation and Energy Committee — 2022-2023
American Bar Association

Economics Ambassador — 2021-2022
American Bar Association

## Additional Experience

NBER Entrepreneurship Research Bootcamp — 2023
Summer school in Entrepreneurship & Innovation

Research Assistant for Ginger Zhe Jin — 2022-2023
University of Maryland

Research Assistant for Andrew Sweeting — 2021-2022
University of Maryland

NBER Digitization Tutorial — 2021
Additional classes in Digital Economics

Research Assistant for Marco Ottaviani — 2017
Bocconi University

Research Assistant at LEAR — 2018
Economic Consulting

IGIER Visiting Student — 2015-2016
Bocconi University

## Skills & Languages

Languages: English (Fluent), Italian (Native), Spanish (Beginner)
Programming: Stata, MATLAB, R, Mathematica, Python, oTree, Latex

*Last updated: October 23, 2026.*